

Polar bears can live in chilly Arctic regions because they are warm-blooded and have thick fur.



Warm blood

Mammals are warm-blooded, which means they can warm up and cool down their bodies to keep their temperature level. An elephant in the hot jungle has the same temperature as a polar bear in the snow.

Hairy beasts

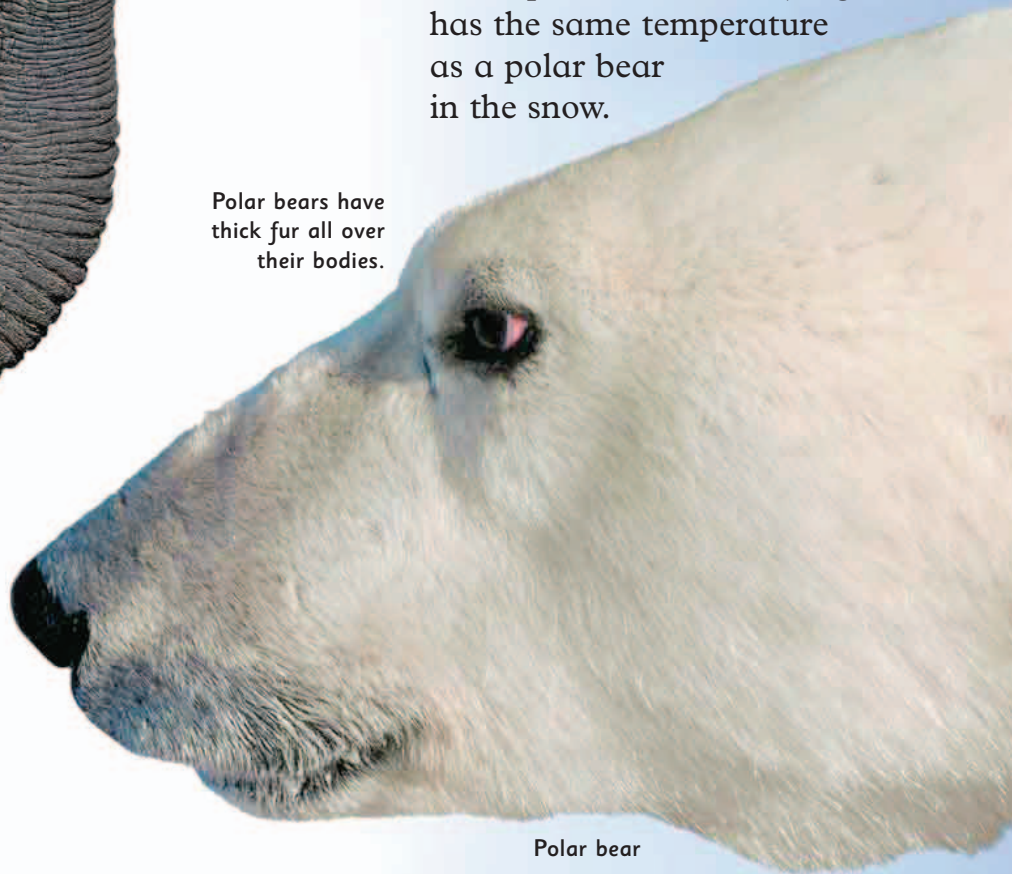
All mammals have hairy bodies, though some are much hairier than others.

This hair, or fur, keeps them warm.

Elephant trunk

This elephant may not look hairy but it does have hair on its body.

Polar bears have thick fur all over their bodies.



Polar bear

Getting around

Mammals have developed different ways of moving about.



Cats: some mammals, such as the cat, have long legs to run with.



Bats: these are the only mammals that can fly – they have wings.



Dolphins: sea mammals have flippers and strong tails to swim with.



Moles: a mole has feet like spades, which are useful for burrowing.



The odd one out

It is usually true that animals give birth to live babies, but there are a few species, including this duck-billed platypus, that lay eggs. Platypus eggs are soft and the size of marbles.